

JULY 2026 | #SICSSNIGERIA



SICSS Nigeria 2026 marks the first national edition of the Summer Institute in Computational Social Science (SICSS), bringing together the communities of SICSS Uyo, SICSS Calabar, and SICSS Lagos into a single institute. SICSS was co-founded in 2017 by Professors Chris Bail and Matt Salganik.

About SICSS Nigeria 2026

Hosted in Uyo, Nigeria, from July 20–31, the Institute brought together a vibrant community of professors, lecturers, researchers, postgraduate students, and industry professionals committed to using computational methods to better understand and address society's most pressing challenges.

This year's edition, themed "Tech for Open Minds", welcomed 20 participants from across Nigeria through a hybrid model that combined in-person and virtual engagement.

Financial Support

Funding from the Templeton World Charity Foundation and Wiki In Africa was instrumental in making the event a reality. Through their generous support, participants received honoraria, travel support, accommodation, meals, and internet subscriptions, ensuring that financial and geographical barriers did not hinder participation.



Lectures and Group Projects

For two weeks, participants engaged in sessions on various Computational Methods, Research Paper Development, and Fireside Chat with a Research Innovator, creating opportunities for participants to reflect on their own research journeys, future aspirations, and possible innovations.

A key highlight of SICSS Nigeria 2026 was the collaborative group research projects developed by participants during the institute that address important questions about knowledge equity, gender representation, and data on Wikimedia platforms. The teams will collaborate and work towards publication with ongoing mentorship and research support from Wiki In Africa.

All sessions were pre-recorded and are now publicly accessible on the SICSS Nigeria YouTube Channel.

The participants affirmed that this program is valuable to their professional growth. We excitedly look forward to the impact on their respective institutions, communities, and beyond.

We remain grateful to our funders, organizing team, facilitators, support staff, volunteers, and participants for their dedication, enthusiasm, and shared commitment to advancing computational social science in Africa.

Signed: SICSS Nigeria Consolidated Team:

- Dr Rhoda Asuquo (Host, SICSS Uyo)
- Juliet Inyang (SICSS Calabar)
- Yohanna Waliya (SICSS Lagos)

Meet the SICSS Nigeria Consolidated Team



Dr Rhoda Asuquo (SICSS Uyo) Yohanna Waliya (SICSS Lagos) Juliet Inyang (SICSS Calabar)

WORDS OF APPRECIATION

The facilitators were absolutely the best. They put us (online participants) through it all as if we were live in Uyo. Their level of patience, organisation, and expertise is second to none. I hope to put to good use all I've gained from this experience. Thanks to the entire organizing team and super thanks to our generous sponsors, Prof. Chris Bail, Templeton World, and the Wiki In Africa team.

- **Dr. Osakpolo Igbinovia, Ambrose Alli University Ekpoma**

It was truly heartwarming to learn about Wikipedia's data resources. I have used different data repositories for research before, but until this program, I had never realized how robust and readily accessible Wikipedia's data ecosystem is. I am excited to use these resources in my future research.

- **Alabi Temitope Emmanuel, Federal University of Technology, Akure**

SICSS has taken my idea of research above 60% from conception to a research idea. I have learned how to use R to collect and analyse qualitative datasets through Wikidump. This is something I am particularly very grateful for.

- **Samuel Mbuk, University of Uyo**

VISIT SICSS NIGERIA YOUTUBE CHANNEL FOR MORE!